

# Balance and Posture

Moderate evidence base · 12–15 minutes

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*This version: Standard wording*

Read slowly — about 30–45 seconds per paragraph. There is no hurry.

## OPENING · BREATH AND LIGHT

Settle into whatever is supporting you right now. Let the surface take your weight. There is nothing to hold up in this practice. Let it all down.

Take a slow breath in. Let it out slowly. On each out-breath, let a little more of the body's held tension release. The shoulders. The jaw. The hands.

Bring warmth to the top of your head. Let it descend with each breath. This time, let the warmth travel all the way down to the base of your spine — to the pelvis, the sitting bones, the very foundation of your body. The weight of you is here. The centre is here.

## PHASE ONE · THE IDEAL BEING

In front of you there is a figure, standing. You may see them, or simply sense them there — either is right. They are simply standing: not performing, not bracing. Their weight is even. Their spine is easy and long. There is a soft, relaxed steadiness about them.

Notice what this is like when it is not effortful. The slight, continuous movement of the body — barely there — as it makes small adjustments to stay upright. The trusting of the ankles. The quiet hips. The calm in the shoulders. No gripping. No compensating. Just a body that knows where it is in space.

The figure steps into you. Now you are standing — or imagining standing. Either is fine. The ground under your feet. The weight distributing. The length in the spine. The head sitting easily at the top of it all. You are upright. Centred. The balance is happening. It doesn't need managing.

## PHASE TWO · THE ANATOMICAL PATHWAY

Bring your awareness to the back of your skull — the base of the brain. The cerebellum is here. It is always working, always receiving signals from your inner ear, your joints, your muscles. It is the coordinator of balance. Sense it there — not a sharp image, just a sense of something that hums with quiet activity.

Bring attention to your inner ear. The fluid in the semicircular canals, reporting the position of your head. The organs that sense gravity. This information is flowing to the cerebellum right now. Let it flow. Don't interfere. Just attend to it.

Now bring attention to your joints — wherever they are, whatever position they are in. The ankles. The knees. The hips. Each one is sending signals upward, reporting its angle, its tension, its load. The cerebellum receives all of it. Integrates it. Sends corrective signals back out to the postural muscles — the deep muscles of the spine, the stabilisers of the hip, the fine muscles of the ankle.

Now sense yourself upright. Standing. The whole system working as it was built to. Signal in, signal out, balance maintained — not because you are gripping or thinking hard, but because the system is running. Let it run.

#### **CLOSING · BREATH AND LIGHT**

Return to the breath. Return to wherever you are — sitting, lying, resting. You are supported. The practice has been received. The imagery settles.

Carry a fragment of this today: the spine long, the weight dropping through the feet, the balance just happening. In any window of quiet — a slow breath, a pause — return to it. Three long breaths now. The room around you. Enough.

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Pathway: Vestibular (inner ear) and proprioceptive signals → cerebellum → corticospinal and reticulospinal tracts → postural muscles (deep spine, hip stabilisers, ankle).

Free educational resource. Not a medical service. Always work with your clinical team. The three-phase structure is the author's synthesis, not a clinically tested protocol as a unit.